

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead:  9

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: East

Lead:  2

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: South

Lead:  5

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead:  K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 5
♥ 6 5 3 2
♦ 10 4 3
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ A 8 3 2

♥ K 10 9

♦ A J 7

♣ K Q 6



♠ K J 7 6
♥ A 8 7
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 10 8 2

♠ 10 9 4

♥ Q J 4

♦ K Q 5 2

♣ J 9 5

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ 9			

Board 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K J 8 4
♥ A K 7 2
♦ 6 5
♣ K 9 3

♠ 9 7 5 3
♥ 10 9 8
♦ K Q 9 3
♣ J 5



♠ A Q 10 6
♥ 5 4
♦ A 8 7 4
♣ A 8 2

♠ 2
♥ Q J 6 3
♦ J 10 2
♣ Q 10 7 6 4

With two 4-card Majors WEST should respond "up-the-line", bidding ♥s first.

Then, after EAST bids 1♠, WEST has enough points to jump all the way to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
		1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	1♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♠2			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 2
♥ J 10 5 2
♦ J 8 7 3
♣ 9 8 5 3

♠ A 9 6 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ A 9 6 2

♣ J 7



♠ J 7 5
♥ K 9 8 3
♦ 10 4
♣ A K 4 2

♠ K Q 10 8 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 10 6

SOUTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1♠.

NORTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3♠, which SOUTH is strong enough to raise to game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣5			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 6
♥ A J 9
♦ A J 2
♣ A 8 5 2

♠ 10 9 3
♥ K Q 7 5 2
♦ 5 3
♣ Q 6 4



♠ 8 7
♥ 10 6 4
♦ K Q 10 9 6
♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q J 5 4 2
♥ 8 3
♦ 8 7 4
♣ K J 9

WEST has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

EAST adds her 6 points to WEST's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to EAST in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥K			